

Sociolinguistics (ENG510)

- ✚ **What is Sociolinguistics?** Sociolinguistics is the study of the relationship between language and society, examining how language use varies based on social factors like culture, context, and identity.
- ✚ **Sociolinguistics and Linguistics:** Sociolinguistics complements linguistics, which focuses on language structure and grammar, by exploring language use in social contexts.
- ✚ **Sociolinguistics and the Sociology of Language:** Sociolinguistics overlaps with the sociology of language, which examines language as a social institution, but focuses more on language use and variation.
- ✚ **Sociolinguistics and Other Disciplines:** Sociolinguistics draws from anthropology, sociology, psychology, and education to understand language in social contexts.
- ✚ **Sociolinguistic Phenomena and an Imaginary World:** Sociolinguistic phenomena, like language variation and change, can be observed in imaginary worlds, like fictional societies or virtual communities.
- ✚ **Sociolinguistic Phenomena and a Real but Exotic World:** Sociolinguistic phenomena can also be studied in real but exotic cultures, like indigenous communities or minority languages.
- ✚ **Sociolinguistic Phenomena and a Real and Familiar World:** Sociolinguistic phenomena are most relevant in our everyday lives, in our own language use and interactions.
- ✚ **Sociolinguistic Phenomena and We:** Sociolinguistics helps us understand our own language use and its relationship to our identity, culture, and social context.
- ✚ **Sociolinguistic Phenomena and the Changing World:** Sociolinguistics examines how language adapts to changing social contexts, like globalization and migration. Sociolinguistics explores the diversity of language varieties, including dialects, registers, and styles.

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- ✚ **What Are Linguistics Items?** Linguistic items refer to language elements like words, phrases, and grammatical structures.
- ✚ **The Terms- Variety and Lect:** Variety refers to a language variant, while lect refers to a specific language or dialect.
- ✚ **Types and Significance of Varieties of Language:** Varieties of language can be regional, social, or functional, and understanding them is crucial for communication and social cohesion.
- ✚ **Attitude towards Language Varieties:** Sociolinguistics examines how speakers' attitudes towards language varieties affect language use and identity.
- ✚ **What Are Speech Communities?** Speech communities are groups of people who share a common language or dialect and social norms of communication. Speech communities can be defined by geographic location, social identity, or language use.
- ✚ **Intersecting Communities:** Speech communities can intersect or overlap, leading to complex language use and identity negotiations.
- ✚ **Rejecting the Idea of Speech Communities:** Some scholars argue that speech communities are too simplistic a concept, and language use is more complex and dynamic.

✚ **Networks and Repertoires**

- Networks refer to the social connections and relationships between speakers
- Repertoires refer to the range of language varieties and styles that speakers have access to and use in different contexts

✚ **LANGUAGE CONTACT AND VARIATION**

- Language contact occurs when speakers of different languages or varieties interact and influence each other's language use
 - Variation refers to the different forms and uses of language that emerge from language contact and change
- ✚ **Sociolinguistics Constraints on language Contact:** Sociolinguistic constraints refer to the social factors that influence language contact and variation, such as social status, power dynamics, and cultural norms
 - ✚ **Wave Model of Language Contact and Change:** The wave model describes how language change spreads through a population, with new forms and uses of language emerging and spreading like waves

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✚ **Spatial Diffusion by Gravity:** Spatial diffusion refers to the spread of language variations through geographic space, with language change spreading from central to peripheral areas

✚ **Access to the Codes:** Access to the codes refers to the ability of speakers to use and understand different language varieties and styles

✚ **Rigidity of the Social Matrix**

- The social matrix refers to the social structures and norms that shape language use and variation
- Rigidity refers to the degree to which the social matrix restricts or allows language change and variation

✚ **Variables and Variants**

- Variables refer to the social and linguistic factors that influence language use and variation
- Variants refer to the different forms and uses of language that emerge from language contact and change

✚ **Types of Variables and Variants**

- **Synchronic variation** refers to the different language varieties and styles used by speakers at a given time
- **Diachronic variation** refers to the change and development of language over time
- Example: A synchronic variant may be the use of a local dialect, while a diachronic variant may be the emergence of a new language variety over time.

✚ **Language Varieties:** Language varieties refer to the different forms and uses of language that emerge from language contact and change

✚ **Difference Between a Language and a Dialect:**

- A language is a system of communication with a shared grammar and vocabulary
- A dialect is a variety of a language with its own distinct grammar, vocabulary, and pronunciation

✚ **Some Examples of Dialects:**

- Regional dialects (e.g. Southern American English)
- Social dialects (e.g. African American Vernacular English)
- Historical dialects (e.g. Old English)

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- ✚ **Standard Languages:** Standard languages are varieties of language that are widely accepted and used in formal situations. Example: Standard American English is a standard language used in formal situations, while a local dialect may be used in informal situations.
- ✚ **The Delimitation of Languages:** The delimitation of languages refers to the process of defining and distinguishing between languages and dialects
- ✚ **The Family Tree Model:** The family tree model describes the historical relationships between languages, with languages branching off from a common ancestor
- ✚ **LANGUAGE AND DIALECTS:** A language is a system of communication with a shared grammar and vocabulary. A dialect is a variety of a language with its own distinct grammar, vocabulary, and pronunciation
- ✚ **Regional Dialects:** Regional dialects are dialects spoken in a specific geographic area. Examples: Southern American English, Punjabi in the Punjab province of Pakistan
- ✚ **Social Dialects:** Social dialects are dialects spoken by specific social groups. Examples: African American Vernacular English, Hindko in northwestern Pakistan
- ✚ **Idiolects:** An idiolect is a person's unique way of speaking, including their vocabulary, grammar, and pronunciation.
- ✚ **Dialects and Identity:** Dialects can be an important part of a person's identity, including their geographic location, social group, and cultural background.
- ✚ **Study of Dialects in Sociolinguistics:** Sociolinguistics is the study of the relationship between language and society, including the study of dialects and their social significance.
- ✚ **Language and Dialect in Papua New Guinea:** Papua New Guinea has over 800 languages spoken, with many dialects and regional variations.
- ✚ **Language and Dialect in Europe:** Europe has many languages and dialects, with some countries having multiple official languages.
- ✚ **Language and Dialects in Africa:** Africa has over 2,000 languages spoken, with many dialects and regional variations
- ✚ **Language and Dialects in Pakistan:** Pakistan has over 70 languages spoken, with many dialects and regional variation

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- ✚ **Language in Society:** Language plays a crucial role in society, including communication, identity, and culture.
- ✚ **Regional Dialectology:** Regional dialectology is the study of dialects in specific geographic areas.
- ✚ **The Work of Labov:** William Labov is a linguist who has studied dialects and language change, including his famous study on Martha's Vineyard.
- ✚ **Martha's Vineyard:** Martha's Vineyard is an island off the coast of Massachusetts where Labov studied the dialect and language change among the island's residents.
- ✚ **Developments in the Study of Language Variation:** The study of language variation has evolved to include new approaches, methods, and theories, such as sociolinguistics, pragmatics, and discourse analysis.
- ✚ **Further Insights into the Study of Language Variation:** Language variation is influenced by social, cultural, and contextual factors, and studying it reveals the complexity and diversity of language use.
- ✚ **What is a Register?** A register is a variety of language defined by its use in a specific social context, such as formal or informal situations.
- ✚ **Some Examples of Register:** Formal register (e.g., news broadcasting), informal register (e.g., conversation with friends), technical register (e.g., medical or legal language).
- ✚ **How a Register is Different from a Dialect:** A register is defined by its use in a specific context, while a dialect is a regional or social variety of language with its own distinct grammar, vocabulary, and pronunciation.
- ✚ **What is Jargon?** Jargon refers to specialized or technical language used by a particular group or profession.
- ✚ **Difference in a Register and Jargon:** A register is a broader term that encompasses various language varieties, while jargon is a specific type of language used by a particular group.
- ✚ **What is Accent?** An accent refers to the way a person pronounces words and sounds in a language, influenced by their native language or regional background.
- ✚ **Accents vs. Dialect:** An accent refers to pronunciation, while a dialect encompasses grammar, vocabulary, and pronunciation.

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- ✚ **What is Style?** Style refers to a person's unique way of using language, including their tone, vocabulary, and grammar.
- ✚ **Register vs. Style:** A register is a variety of language defined by its use in a specific context, while style is a person's individual way of using language.
- ✚ **Speech communities and communicative competence:** Speech communities are groups of people who share a common language and communicative norms, and communicative competence refers to the ability to use language effectively in a particular speech community.
- ✚ **The Term-Code:** Code refers to a language or variety of language used in a specific context.
- ✚ **Bilingualism:** Bilingualism refers to the ability to speak two languages fluently.
- ✚ **Bilinguality vs. Bilingualism:** Bilinguality refers to the state of being bilingual, while bilingualism refers to the social and cultural contexts of language use.
- ✚ **Bi/Multilingualism and Sociolinguistics:** Bi/multilingualism is the ability to speak multiple languages, and sociolinguistics studies the social and cultural contexts of language use.
- ✚ **Measuring Bilingualism:** Bilingualism can be measured through language proficiency tests, language use surveys, and linguistic analysis.

✚ **SOCIOLINGUISTICS AND USE OF CODES**

- **Code switching:** switching between two or more languages or varieties in a single conversation or text.
Example: A bilingual speaker switching between English and Spanish in a conversation with a friend.
- **Code mixing:** mixing elements of two or more languages or varieties in a single sentence or utterance.
Example: "I'm gonna go store, comprar some milk" (mixing English and Spanish).
- **Tag switching:** switching between two or more languages or varieties in a single utterance, often to add emphasis or clarify meaning.
Example: "I'm so angry, ¡estoy furioso!" (switching from English to Spanish to add emphasis).

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- **Hybridization:** the blending of different languages or varieties to create a new form of communication. Example: Spanglish (a blend of Spanish and English) or Singlish (a blend of Singaporean languages).

SOCIAL CORRELATES AND SOCIOLINGUISTICS

- **Social class as a social correlate:** language use can vary based on social class, with different classes using different language varieties or styles.
Example: In some societies, a particular accent or dialect may be associated with a higher or lower social class.
- **Gender as a social correlate:** language use can vary based on gender, with men and women using different language varieties or styles.
Example: In some cultures, women may use more polite language or avoid using certain words or phrases considered masculine.
- **Age as a social correlate:** language use can vary based on age, with different age groups using different language varieties or styles.
Example: Younger people may use more informal language or slang, while older people may use more formal language.
- **Ethnic varieties as social correlates:** language use can vary based on ethnic identity, with different ethnic groups using different language varieties or styles.
Example: In the United States, African American Vernacular English (AAVE) is a distinct language variety used by many African Americans.

Speech Communities, Social Networks and Communities of Practice

- **Speech communities:** groups of people who share a common language or language variety.
Example: A group of friends who speak a particular dialect or language.
- **Social networks:** relationships between individuals or groups that can influence language use.
Example: A person's social network may influence their language use, with friends and family members using certain words or phrases.
- **Communities of practice:** groups of people who share a common interest or activity and use language in a specific way.
Example: A group of gamers who use specific terminology and language styles when playing games together.

SOCIO-POLITICAL FACTORS AND SOCIOLINGUISTICS

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- **Language and Identity:** Language is a key aspect of a person's identity, and can be used to signal membership in a particular group or community.
Example: A person's accent or dialect can reveal their geographic origin or social background.
- **Dialects and Identity:** Dialects can be a powerful marker of identity, with speakers often having strong emotional attachments to their dialect.
Example: A person from the Southern United States may strongly identify with their Southern dialect.
- **Language, Style Variation, and Socio-Psychological Factors:** Language use can vary depending on social context, with speakers using different styles to signal social status, age, gender, etc.
Example: A person may use a more formal style in a professional setting, but a more informal style with friends.
- **Politeness and Sociolinguistics:** Politeness is a key aspect of social interaction, and language use can be used to show respect, deference, or courtesy.
Example: Using phrases like "please" and "thank you" to show politeness.
- **Power in Sociolinguistics:** Language use can be used to exert power over others, with dominant groups often imposing their language on subordinate groups.
Example: In a multilingual society, the dominant group may impose their language as the official language.
- **Language and Ideology:** Language can be used to promote political ideologies, with language use often reflecting political beliefs.
Example: Political speeches often use language to promote a particular ideology.
- **The Ideology of Standard Language:** Standard languages are often seen as superior to non-standard dialects, and can be used to promote a particular political ideology.
Example: In some countries, the standard language is seen as a symbol of national identity.
- **Multilingual Societies and Status of Languages:** In multilingual societies, languages can have different status, with some languages being seen as more prestigious than others.

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Example: In a multilingual country, the official language may be seen as more prestigious than minority languages.

- **Language and Education:** Language use can vary depending on educational setting, with formal education often promoting standard languages.

Example: In a school setting, students may be encouraged to use the standard language rather than their native dialect.

- **Language Policy and Planning:** Language policy and planning can be used to promote or suppress particular languages or dialects.

Example: A government may promote a particular language as the official language, or suppress minority languages.

LANGUAGE AND IDEOLOGY

- Language can be used to promote political ideologies, with language use often reflecting political beliefs.
- Example: In North Korea, the government promotes a specific language ideology that emphasizes the superiority of the Korean language and culture.

The History of Galim/ Language in North and South Korea

- Galim is a language that was once spoken in North and South Korea, but has since been replaced by other languages.
- Example: In North Korea, Galim was seen as a symbol of resistance against Japanese colonization, while in South Korea, it was seen as a reminder of the country's divided past.

Language in Great Britain

- Great Britain has a complex language landscape, with English being the dominant language, but other languages such as Welsh, Scottish Gaelic, and Irish also being spoken.
- Example: In Wales, Welsh is an official language and is used in government and education, while in Scotland, Scottish Gaelic is recognized as a minority language.

Language in the USA

- The USA is a multilingual country, with English being the dominant language, but other languages such as Spanish, Chinese, and Native American languages also being spoken.

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- Example: In California, Spanish is widely spoken, while in New York City, many languages are spoken, including Chinese, Russian, and Korean.

Language in Canada

- Canada is a bilingual country, with English and French being the official languages, but other languages such as Indigenous languages and immigrant languages also being spoken.
- Example: In Quebec, French is the dominant language, while in Toronto, many languages are spoken, including English, Chinese, and Punjabi.

Language Change and Maintenance

- Language change refers to the evolution of a language over time, while language maintenance refers to the efforts made to preserve a language.
- Example: In many Indigenous communities, language maintenance programs are in place to preserve traditional languages.

Language Shift

- Language shift refers to the process of switching from one language to another, often due to social or economic factors.
- Example: In many immigrant communities, language shift occurs as younger generations prefer to speak the dominant language of their new country.

Language Desertion

- Language desertion refers to the abandonment of a language, often due to social or economic factors.
- Example: In many Indigenous communities, language desertion has occurred due to colonization and forced assimilation.

Language Death

- Language death refers to the extinction of a language, often due to social or economic factors.
- Example: Many Indigenous languages have died out due to colonization and forced assimilation.

Language Accommodation

- Language accommodation refers to the process of adapting one's language to communicate with others, often in multilingual settings.

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- Example: In many multilingual communities, language accommodation occurs as speakers adapt their language to communicate with others.

Pidgin and Creole

- Pidgins and Creoles are languages that emerge in multilingual settings, often as a result of colonialism or trade.
- Example: Hawaiian Creole English emerged as a result of contact between Native Hawaiians and European colonizers.

Origins and Structures of Pidgins and Creoles

- Pidgins and Creoles have unique linguistic structures, often simplified and adapted for communication in multilingual settings.
- Example: Tok Pisin, a pidgin language spoken in Papua New Guinea, has a simplified grammar and vocabulary.

The Creole Continuum

- The Creole continuum refers to the range of languages that emerge in multilingual settings, from pidgins to Creoles.
- Example: In the Caribbean, a Creole continuum exists, with languages ranging from pidgins to Creoles such as Jamaican Patois.

Pidgins and Creoles in Social Context

- Pidgins and Creoles are often used in social contexts such as trade, colonization, and migration.
- Example: In many African countries, pidgins and Creoles are used as lingua francas for trade and communication.

Groups by Maha Malik

<https://chat.whatsapp.com/DxMf8E7A78d6EVdqjbOzI>